IELTS ACADEMIC · RESTRICTED STAFF MATERIAL

IELTS Academic Set 24

PRIVATE STAFF answer key and Listening transcript

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Answer keys and Listening transcripts are restricted to staff.

Listening

Question	Answer	Accepted variants
1	Bramble	
2	lurcher	
3	3	three
4	4827	
5	March	
6	text message	text
7	A	
8	C	
9	B	
10	A	
11	C	
12	F	
13	A	
14	H	
15	D	
16	B	
17	weather forecast	forecast
18	yellow	
19	charged phone	phone

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Question	Answer	Accepted variants
20	turn back	
21	B	
22	C	
23	B	
24	A	
25	C	
26	B	
27	A	
28	B	
29	C	
30	A	
31	air spaces	
32	waxy coat	
33	ocean currents	currents
34	tide line	tideline
35	fresh water	
36	stable soil	
37	viability	
38	turbulence	
39	sampling	
40	competition	

Listening transcript

Part 1 - A Dublin resident phones a community veterinary clinic to register her dog and arrange a vaccination appointment.

SEÁN	Good morning, Harbour Community Veterinary Clinic. Seán speaking. How can I help?
NIAMH	Hi. I'm calling about the low-cost vaccination clinic. We moved across Dublin last month, and I'd like to register my dog before I book a time. I have the rescue paperwork here, although one page is only a photocopy.
SEÁN	That's fine. I'll enter the basic details first, then we'll look at locations and times. If anything clinical is unclear, the nurse can check it when you arrive. What's your dog's name?
NIAMH	His name is Bramble - B R A M B L E. The receptionist at our old clinic once wrote Brandon, so I always spell it now.

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SEÁN	Bramble. Got it. And what breed should I put on the form? We use the description from the animal's records, rather than guessing from appearance.
NIAMH	They wondered whether he had some collie in him, but every official page says lurcher. So please put lurcher.
SEÁN	Certainly. How old is he now? An approximate age is acceptable for a rescue dog if that is all you were given.
NIAMH	We do know it. He turned three in January. His adoption form still says two, but that was completed before his birthday.
SEÁN	Thanks. Next I need the final four digits of the microchip number. They should be below the barcode on the original certificate.
NIAMH	I've found it. The photocopy ends four, two, eight, seven, but someone switched the middle digits. The original certificate ends four, eight, two, seven - that's 4827 on the form.
SEÁN	Right, I've recorded that. Do you know the month of his last annual vaccination? I only need the month today; we'll verify the full date from the booklet.
NIAMH	Yes, it was in March. We adopted him in February, then the rescue centre arranged the vaccination the following month.
SEÁN	One last registration detail: how should we confirm the appointment? We can call, email, or send a short message to your mobile. The confirmation will include the location, arrival instructions, and our cancellation number.
NIAMH	A text message would be best. I rarely hear my phone while I'm working, and clinic emails sometimes disappear into the junk folder, but I check texts at lunch.
SEÁN	That's the registration done. Let's find an appointment that fits your journey and Bramble's routine. The main surgery on O'Connell Street has indoor slots, and on Wednesdays our mobile clinic parks beside the library in Rathmines. There's also a Saturday van at the school car park.
NIAMH	I'll choose the mobile clinic beside the library. Parking near the main surgery is difficult, and the school is across the city. The library is a short walk from my office, so I can bring Bramble over after work.
SEÁN	Let me check next Wednesday. I can offer nine-fifteen, a cancellation at twelve-thirty, or the final appointment at four-forty-five. Each slot lasts twenty minutes, and the van closes immediately after the last patient has been seen that evening.
NIAMH	Bramble is fine in the morning, and transport isn't the issue. I have a work meeting that runs until three, so the two earlier times are impossible. Four-forty-five is the one I can manage.
SEÁN	I've booked that. Please arrive ten minutes early and bring his vaccination record, even though some entries came from the rescue centre. We can scan the chip at the van, so the chip certificate is optional, and we don't need proof of address.
NIAMH	Just the vaccination record, then. That's easier than carrying the whole adoption file. I'll put the booklet beside his lead this evening so it comes with us.
SEÁN	Good. Payment is taken at the van, and you can pay by card when you arrive. The link on our website is only for donations; it won't accept clinic fees. We no longer take cash at the mobile service.

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NIAMH	Card on arrival is perfect. Is there anything about the queue I should know?
SEÁN	Keep him on a short lead and wait beside the blue sign until the nurse calls you. If he seems unwell that day, phone first rather than bringing him into the queue.
NIAMH	Understood. I'll watch for the confirmation message. Thanks for your help.
SEÁN	You're welcome. The text should arrive this afternoon. Goodbye.

Part 2 - A ranger gives winter safety directions for a fictional coastal trail in County Donegal.

AOIFE	Welcome to the winter briefing for the Carrick Bay coastal trail. I'm Aoife Gallagher, one of the rangers. The cliff section is closed today, so everyone must use the signed inland diversion shown on your map. I'll describe the route in walking order, then explain four safety decisions. Keep the map facing north: several tracks look alike where they leave the bay, especially when low cloud hides the headland.
AOIFE	Begin in the car park in the south-west corner. Before you join the trail, look to the right, along the north edge of the parking area. The information board is there, beside the water tap. Do not confuse it with the small notice fixed to the toilets opposite. The main board carries today's closure, the ranger telephone number, and the route-check time, so each group should stop there.
AOIFE	From the board, take the pale gravel path north-east. It reaches a low stone bridge over the stream. Cross the bridge but do not turn beside it; the narrow track following the bank serves the fields. Continue until the gravel becomes dark compacted earth at a wooden barrier on the coast. That barrier is the tide gate. You may hear the sea before you see it, but stay on the maintained surface until you reach the gate.
AOIFE	In summer the usual trail passes through that barrier and follows the shore. In winter, waves can cut off the beach with very little warning. The start of the winter diversion lies just before the gate, on its eastern side. Choose the narrower path bending inland, marked by two orange arrows. The broad track continuing north looks easier, but it leads towards the closed shore and must not be used.
AOIFE	The diversion climbs gradually between two fields. First you pass emergency marker two beside a dry-stone wall. That is not the point you need to label. Continue to the next bend, where a line of wind-shaped pine trees crosses your view. Immediately beyond the trees stands emergency marker three. The number is printed on both faces of the yellow post, so you can identify it when walking in either direction.
AOIFE	After marker three, the path descends towards two buildings near the service road. The larger grey building is the ranger store, which is locked to visitors. The warming shelter is the smaller building west of it, directly beside the walking path. It has a green roof and a covered doorway. If you reach the vehicle barrier by the store, you have gone too far east and should return to the path.
AOIFE	Beyond the shelter, continue north and ignore the right-hand track dropping to the beach steps; those steps are closed. The safe trail curves left around the headland. It finishes at the lookout point, just south of the north arrow on your map. A rope barrier marks the end. There is no second exit beyond it, so anyone who is already tired should turn around at the shelter rather than attempt the final exposed section.

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AOIFE	To recap the map: you leave the car park by the information board, cross the stone bridge, and reach the tide gate. The winter path then turns inland past marker three and the warming shelter before ending at the lookout. The bridge, marker two, ranger store, and beach steps are useful landmarks, but they are not the six locations you are being asked to identify.
AOIFE	Now, the safety details. Conditions on the headland can differ sharply from those in the nearest town, and clear sky above the car park tells you nothing about mist moving in from the water. Before leaving home, check the weather forecast specifically for this coast. If the warning is amber or red, postpone the walk rather than hoping it will improve.
AOIFE	Some older online photographs show red emergency posts, and a few faded red bases remain beside the path. Those markers were replaced two years ago: every current marker is yellow. In an emergency, quote the number on the nearest yellow post so the rescue team knows which approach to use.
AOIFE	Carry drinking water and an extra warm layer, even for a short walk. A paper map is useful when reception is weak, but it cannot be used to call for help. Put a charged phone in a waterproof bag and check its battery before leaving. The rescue team asks you to protect that phone from spray because it provides both contact and a location reading.
AOIFE	At the tide gate, inspect the striped depth post before taking the inland turn. If water already covers the lower white band, turn back. Do not wait beside the gate for the level to drop, since the next surge may be higher, and never try to reach the diversion by stepping across wet rocks. The safe decision applies even when other walkers appear to be continuing.
AOIFE	Children should stay on the inland side of the path, and dogs must remain on a lead. The warming shelter has blankets, a first-aid box, and an emergency radio, but no café or drinking water. It is for short emergency stops, not planned lunch breaks, so carry your own supplies.
AOIFE	If mist closes in after marker three, return to the shelter rather than pressing on. The final section becomes confusing when the barrier and coastline disappear. Rangers inspect the route at closing time, but that does not replace turning around promptly.
AOIFE	Finally, copy the ranger number before setting off and tell someone when you expect to return. Allow extra time for the inland climb, follow the diversion signs, and let the conditions decide how far you go.

Part 3 - Two conservation students and their tutor refine a controlled light-exposure study of dyed textile replicas in Melbourne.

OLIVIA	Let's go through the light-exposure proposal before you submit it. Fading in dyed textiles is a suitable conservation topic, but your research question still needs to be precise enough for a six-week study. I also want the method to explain each control, not simply list equipment.
MEI	Our first idea was to borrow tiny nineteenth-century fragments from the teaching collection. They're already damaged and rarely displayed, so we assumed a little additional exposure would be acceptable. We would have returned them after every weekly reading.
OLIVIA	That would still cause irreversible change to original material. When the same question can be answered with a replica, there is no ethical reason to consume a collection object. Use newly dyed wool swatches instead. You can make enough pieces for repetition, and their known recipes will help you interpret unexpected fading.
LACHLAN	That solves the sample-size problem too. I can cut all the swatches from one bolt and distribute pieces from different areas across the treatments. Otherwise, a slightly tighter section of weave might make one lamp group look more stable than the other.

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MEI	For the research question, could we simply compare a bright display case with a dim one? It would be easy to explain to visitors, and the visual difference should appear quickly.
OLIVIA	It would appear quickly because the result is almost built into the design. Your better proposal compares two LED spectra at equal cumulative exposure. That tests spectral composition instead of merely confirming that more light causes more damage. Measure each lamp's output; its colour label is not precise enough.
LACHLAN	For colour change, I planned to photograph the swatches every Friday with the camera fixed to a stand. I could include a grey card and keep the room lights off, which should make the images fairly consistent.
OLIVIA	Keep the photographs as a visual record, but don't make them the main data. Camera settings, processing, and screens can alter appearance. Take baseline and weekly colorimeter readings for repeatable numerical measurements. Average several points on each swatch so one dark fibre does not control the result.
MEI	If the blue-rich lamp appears brighter, should both sets still stay under their lamps for the same number of hours? Changing the schedule might look like we're treating the samples differently.
OLIVIA	Equal hours are not necessarily equal exposure; one lamp may deliver more energy per hour. Adjust the duration so both groups receive the same total light dose. Then spectrum remains the independent variable. Include the calculation so another researcher can reproduce the schedule with lamps of different power.
LACHLAN	We also planned to keep a third set in a cupboard. I described those swatches as spares in case one of the exposed pieces is dropped or stained. Is that sufficient?
OLIVIA	No, the dark set has an analytical purpose. It reveals colour changes caused by reasons other than light, such as handling or dye instability. Keep it in the same room for comparable temperature and humidity, open it only for measurements, and handle it exactly like the illuminated swatches.
MEI	There is one awkward feature of the exposure shelf: the corner near the power unit is slightly warmer. We could record that temperature and leave every swatch in one fixed position, then discuss any unusual result from that corner.
OLIVIA	Recording temperature is useful, but fixed samples would make location a hidden variable. Randomise the swatch positions each week, spreading shelf differences across treatments instead of confusing them with one lamp. Prepare the sequence in advance and retain it in the laboratory log.
LACHLAN	When we interpret the results, could we say that the stronger exposure represents twenty years in a gallery? That would give the museum a practical number for planning displays.
OLIVIA	You can compare treatments, but don't make that conversion. Short, intense exposure may not reproduce slow ageing under gallery conditions; reactions can change with intensity, temperature, and rest periods. State that as the main limitation and recommend longer observation before translating results into display years.
MEI	So the revised design uses replica wool, two spectra at an equal dose, instrument measurements, a dark control, and weekly randomisation. The result will compare treatments, not predict an exact lifetime.

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OLIVIA	Exactly. Now let's allocate the four remaining decisions before we finish. Each line in the responsibility table needs one named lead and a short note about the evidence that person will retain. You may assist one another in the laboratory, but a reader should be able to see who maintains the record or has authority to approve a limit.
MEI	I've already tested the dye recipes, so I can maintain the preparation log. I'll enter fibre weight, dye concentration, bath temperature, and every batch number as the swatches are made. That will be more reliable than trying to reconstruct a batch from labels on the drying trays.
LACHLAN	Then I'll handle the colorimeter calibration. I used the same model during my placement. Before every weekly session I'll run the white-tile check, record the result, and repeat it if the instrument has drifted beyond the manufacturer's tolerance.
OLIVIA	Good. The maximum exposure ceiling must be approved by me. It affects laboratory safety and sets the point beyond which the accelerated treatment would no longer be ethically or scientifically defensible. You can calculate the proposed dose, but place my name in the approval column.
MEI	That leaves the replica cloth. I met the textile workshop manager last term, so I'll contact the workshop and confirm the fibre specification, weave, quantity, and delivery date. I'll copy Lachlan into the message because he needs the cloth dimensions for the cutting plan.
LACHLAN	I can help label the swatches once they arrive, and Mei can observe the first calibration. Those shared activities won't change the four named leads, will they?
OLIVIA	No. Distinguish routine assistance from responsibility for a conservation decision or its formal record. In the report, state the lead first and then note any supporting work. That makes the method auditable without pretending the project was completed by four isolated individuals.
MEI	We'll revise the responsibility table this afternoon, attach the dose calculation, and add the randomisation schedule as an appendix.
OLIVIA	Send me that version before Friday. If the exposure ceiling, calibration record, and replica specification are clear, you can begin preparing the swatches next week. Keep the photographs in the plan, but remember they support the instrument data rather than replace it.

Part 4 - A New Zealand university lecture explains mechanisms and limitations of ocean-drift seed dispersal to islands.

LECTURER	Today we're examining ocean-drift dispersal: the possibility that seeds cross salt water and establish on islands without deliberate human transport. The familiar image is simple - a seed floats, reaches a beach, and grows - but those are separate biological filters. Researchers therefore distinguish transport, arrival, germination, and establishment. Evidence that a seed passes one filter cannot be treated as proof that it will pass the next, and the probability of success narrows at every stage.
LECTURER	The first transport filter is buoyancy. Size alone is a poor guide: a large seed whose tissues fill with water may sink, while a smaller one with persistent internal cavities can float. The crucial feature is air spaces within the outer tissue, which reduce overall density and keep the seed near the surface. Experiments use several intact samples because one cracked coat or unusually dense individual may behave differently.

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LECTURER	A second useful feature protects the embryo from immediate salt exposure. Abrasion and pre-existing cracks reduce that protection, and microscopic wear increases permeability during a long voyage. The barrier is a waxy coat, which slows the entry of sea water but never makes the seed permanently waterproof. Its value therefore depends on both its condition and the journey's length.
LECTURER	Once afloat, a seed may move along a coast, enter open water, and approach another island. The main driver is ocean currents, not the wind direction observed on one day. Multi-year drifter records reveal recurring pathways, but they still express probabilities. Storms can push an individual away from the average route or hold it in circulating water much longer.
LECTURER	Arrival creates another filter. Waves may throw seeds onto bare rock, where they dry or wash back immediately. Storm debris offers a better chance when it catches a seed at the tide line, above ordinary waves. Leaves and wood can provide shade and reduce movement, though heavy debris may bury the seed too deeply. A favourable feature at one stage can therefore create a later problem.
LECTURER	A stranded seed remains surrounded by salt. Repeated rain gradually lowers the concentration around the embryo and allows early metabolism to begin. The rain supplies fresh water, which drains through the upper beach and flushes the coat and sand. Tests that replace salt water instantly may exaggerate the benefit, because natural flushing is intermittent and depends on grain size and drainage.
LECTURER	A viable, desalted seed still cannot establish on ground that shifts with every wave. The emerging root needs stable soil for anchorage, while organic matter retains moisture. The balance matters: saturated ground may lack oxygen, whereas rapidly draining sand leaves seedlings dry. Establishment also requires light and a period without renewed storm disturbance.
LECTURER	We can now summarise six linked opportunities: flotation supported by air spaces; slower water entry through a waxy coat; movement by ocean currents; capture at the tide line; salt removal by fresh water; and anchorage in stable soil. This is not a recipe that guarantees colonisation. Failure at any point ends that individual's journey, and real coastlines may impose additional filters, including predators, unsuitable seasons, or the absence of compatible soil organisms.
LECTURER	The second half of the problem concerns evidence and its limits. A flotation trial demonstrates buoyancy, but buoyancy alone does not establish viability. A seed may remain on the surface for months while its embryo loses the ability to germinate. A stronger experiment tests germination after different periods in salt water and compares the result with an unexposed control, although even that design still simplifies the voyage.
LECTURER	Laboratory tanks are valuable because temperature, salinity, and duration can be repeated. Their weakness is that they simplify coastal turbulence. Real shores subject seeds to breaking waves, abrasion, burial, and repeated sinking and resurfacing. Wave simulators improve realism, but regular mechanical motion still lacks the unpredictable sequence of calm periods and storms.
LECTURER	Field collections have a different weakness. Researchers often recover only a few stranded seeds, so sampling can bias the apparent success rate. One storm may deposit many seeds on a monitored beach while a nearby shore receives none. Surveys should cover several sites and seasons, though large, recognisable seeds may still be reported more often than damaged specimens.

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LECTURER	Finally, arrival and germination do not equal permanent colonisation. Existing plants may already occupy the available light, nutrients, water, and root space. In other words, competition can eliminate a young plant after every dispersal stage has apparently succeeded. Herbivory, disease, or the absence of pollinators may create further barriers, but competition is often the first ecological explanation tested when seedlings emerge and then disappear.
LECTURER	Genetic evidence can support ocean drift when island plants are closely related to a plausible source population. Similarity, however, does not reveal the route, date, or number of arrivals. Human transport must also be considered for species linked to settlement, gardens, or traded goods.
LECTURER	Researchers therefore combine flotation and germination tests, current models, shoreline surveys, ecology, and genetics. No method reconstructs the whole journey. Ocean dispersal becomes plausible when independent evidence agrees and human movement is less convincing.
LECTURER	In your seminar, separate mechanism from limitation. Explain what permits transport and establishment, then state what each method leaves uncertain. A flotation result is not proof of colonisation, and genetic similarity is not a known route. Rare long-distance events can shape island flora even though most seeds fail.

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Reading

Question	Answer	Accepted variants
1	volume	
2	skeleton	
3	cells	
4	hyphae	
5	overflow	
6	root extension	
7	conditions	
8	B	
9	D	
10	A	
11	C	
12	B	
13	D	
14	FALSE	
15	FALSE	
16	TRUE	
17	TRUE	
18	FALSE	
19	FALSE	
20	NOT GIVEN	
21	a slate	slate
22	notes	
23	music and mathematics	mathematics and music
24	schools and libraries	libraries and schools
25	pins	
26	close textual study	
27	A	
28	G	

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Question	Answer	Accepted variants
29	D	
30	C	
31	B	
32	E	
33	I	
34	sunlight	
35	top layer	
36	metallic reflector	
37	thermal emission	thermal radiation
38	atmospheric window	
39	insulation	
40	roof deck	

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